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OF BASS AND BLUES



FOUR PREMIUM BLUETOOTH SPEAKERS, EACH WITH ITS OWN SET OF ADVANTAGES, BATTLE IT OUT TO BE THE BEST IN CLASS. FIND OUT WHICH ONE COMES OUT ON TOP.

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Premium bluetooth speakers, priced upwards of ₹15,000, are always seen as a luxury. The niche usually brings commendable audio quality to the table, alongside premium looks and additional features that justify the hefty price tags. While you may argue that it is always worth it to pay for good speakers that churn out warm, tight and rich audio, at the premium segment, you cannot be blamed for wanting more than just the essentials.

The four speakers in question here are Boom 2 by Ultimate Ears, B&O's Beoplay A1, and Creative's Sound Blaster Roar and Roar 2, two generations of multi-functioning units that also happen to be speakers. Each offers a different characteristic for prospective buyers. The Boom 2 is geared more towards the youth, with water resistance, funky colours and sturdiness fused with solid, reliable audio performance. Bang & Olufsen have always excelled at luxury gadgets, and the Beoplay A1 brings luxury audio and design to the company's most competitively priced

speaker yet. It looks gorgeous, and sounds equally good, but on the other hand, it lacks a microUSB port (in favour of USB-C) and has no water resistance of any kind.

Creative's wondrous Roar speakers, as you would probably know by now, are ridiculously feature-packed for portable Bluetooth speakers. The second generation Sound Blaster Roar 2 retains all the features that the Roar had, which include microSD playback, native audio controls, audio recording, speakerphone, power bank capabilities, and connectivity via Blue-

tooth, NFC, aux-in and USB audio. You can also charge these speakers via DC-in ports supplied in box, or standard microUSB cables, based on convenience. The Sound Blaster Roar 2 improves on the Roar with a smaller, lighter body and re-engineered mechanism to provide better audio quality.

It is this diversity among these four premium portable Bluetooth speakers that makes for a compelling shootout. Should your speakers solely concentrate on delivering good audio, or do you deserve a mini gadget arsenal for the dough you shell out? Find out.